XYZ

GTM Automation Plan

Sep 27, 2026 · @Jacob

Executive summary

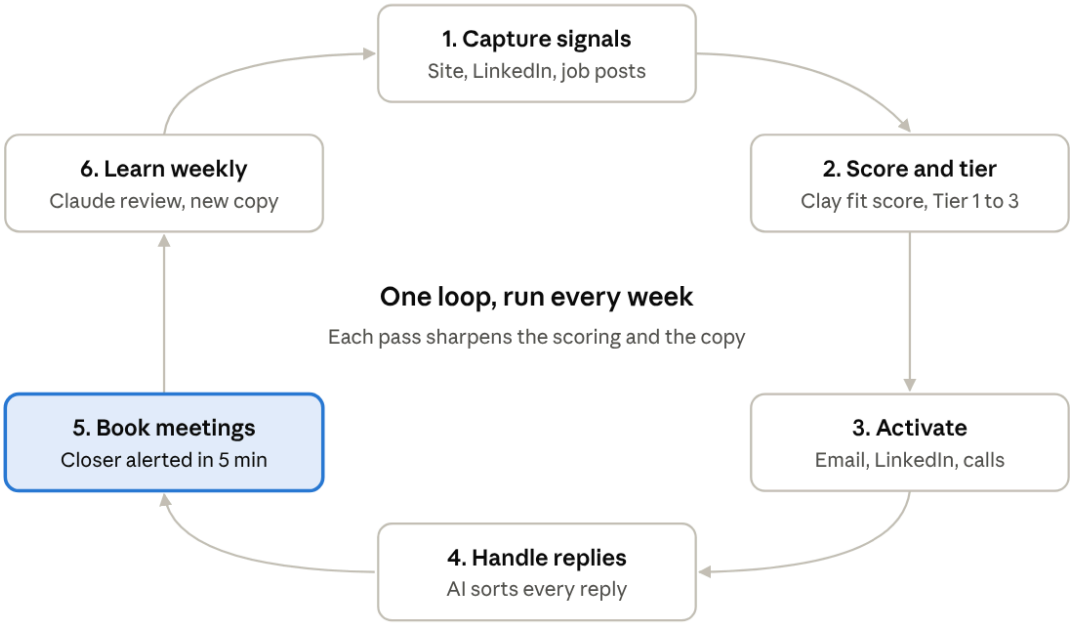
XYZ runs one signal engine: every buying signal lands in Clay, gets scored into Tier 1–3, and fires one of five activation channels — email, LinkedIn DMs, LinkedIn content, calls and nurture. An AI reply agent sorts every response and hands booked meetings to the closer. The engine is built from 56 plays on workflows.io; section 4 maps each one.

What we sell and to whom. XYZ sells to US talent and creator management agencies. Revenue is a percentage of platform volume, roughly $750/month per agency (about $9K a year). That price sets the rules: automation does the volume, and humans touch only Tier 1 accounts and hot replies.

The five systems in this plan

1. **Signal and data layer** — TAM map, ICP scoring, enrichment, HubSpot as the record of truth.
2. **Automated outbound email** — six trigger-based Instantly flows, from cold ICP lists to website visitors and job changers.
3. **Automated reply handling** — n8n + Claude classify every email and LinkedIn reply, answer the routine ones, and alert the closer to the hot ones within 5 minutes.
4. **LinkedIn engine** — founder and team posting 3x a week, engagement capture, and HeyReach DM sequences driven by who engaged.
5. **Feedback loop** — attribution, weekly Claude Code reviews and prompt tuning, so the system improves each week.

The engine is one loop: every reply and meeting makes the next week sharper



The engine loop · 6 steps, repeated weekly

The five systems above sit on this one loop. Steps 1–2 are the data layer, step 3 is outbound and LinkedIn, step 4 is reply handling, and step 6 is the feedback loop.

Operating split. Aakash and the GTM team build and run the engine. The engine books meetings, and the closer runs demos. The brand product uses the same engine with its own ICP, lists and copy.

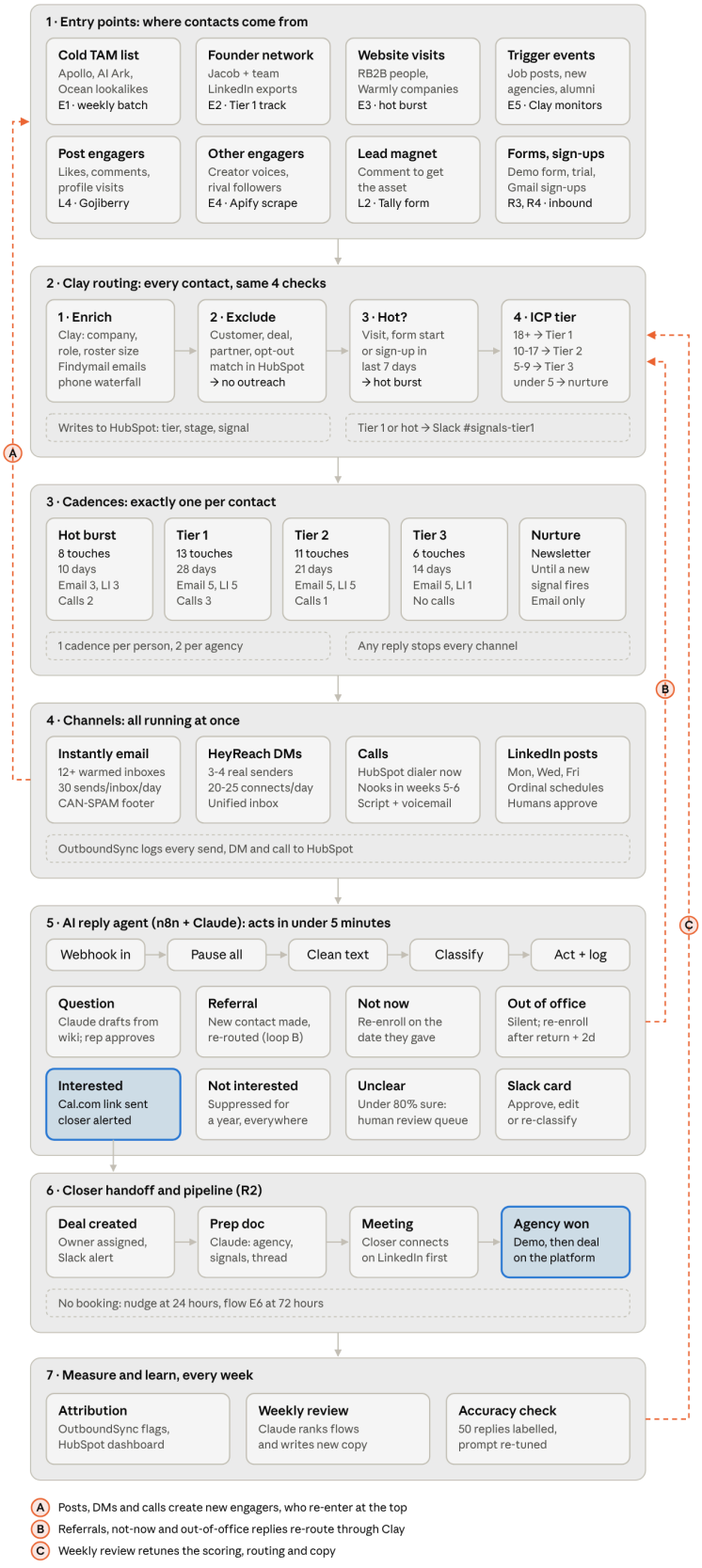
90-day targets to calibrate in week 4: 20+ qualified meetings a month, a positive reply rate above 1.5% on email and above 8% on LinkedIn DMs, and a closer-reviewed reply accuracy above 95%.

The whole system at a glance

All eight entry points feed the same routing layer, so every contact gets exactly one cadence. The channels run side by side, and every reply lands in one agent. The dashed lines are the three loops that keep the engine feeding itself.

Every contact follows one traceable path from first signal to won agency

7 layers, read top to bottom; the dashed lines are the 3 feedback loops



- (A) Posts, DMs and calls create new engagers, who re-enter at the top
- (B) Referrals, not-now and out-of-office replies re-route through Clay
- (C) Weekly review retunes the scoring, routing and copy

Full system map · every path operating together

Read it top to bottom through seven layers: where contacts come from and which tool finds them, the four Clay checks, the five cadences and their channel mix, the four channels with their limits, the reply agent's pipeline and all eight reply outcomes, the closer handoff, and the weekly measurement. Blue boxes mark the path to revenue. The later sections zoom into each layer.

ICP, personas and signals

The ICP is a US agency that manages creators or talent and runs brand deals for them. Start by backtesting the scoring against current customers and pipeline (ICP Modeling Guide). The scoring is right when 95%+ of won accounts score Tier 1–2 (TAM Mapping).

Account scoring (adapted from the Customer Alumni play's point model)

Criterion	Points
US-based agency	+5 (non-US: disqualify)
Agency type: creator or influencer talent management	+5 (sports/NIL or music management: +2; brand-side agency: route to the brand product)
Team size 5–50 on LinkedIn	+5 (2–4: +2; 51–250: +3)
Roster of 15+ managed creators listed on site	+4 (5–14: +2)
Hiring talent managers or brand partnership staff	+3
Runs deals and payouts on spreadsheets, email or a competitor	+3 (already a customer: exclude)
Part of a roll-up or partner network such as The Team (Wasserman)	+3

Tiers: Tier 1 = 18+ points, Tier 2 = 10–17, Tier 3 = 5–9, below 5 = nurture only. Account fit sets the tier. Signals then raise the priority inside a tier, following the TAM Mapping rule of scoring fit without intent.

Buying committee

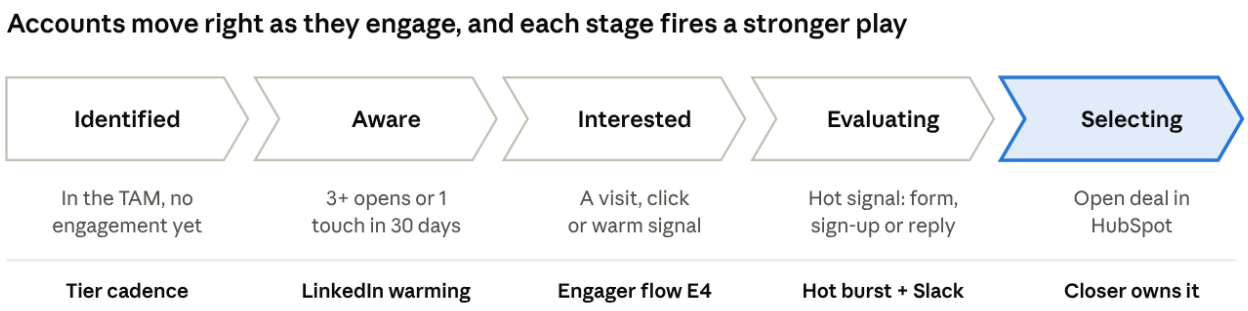
Role	Typical titles	What they care about	Channel lead
Decision maker	Founder, CEO, Managing Partner	Revenue per creator, margin, getting paid faster	Founder-to-founder email + LinkedIn DM
Champion	Head of Talent, Senior Talent Manager	Less admin per deal, more deals per manager	LinkedIn content + DM
User	Talent Manager, Brand Partnerships Manager	Faster deal flow, fewer spreadsheets	Email sequences
Finance and ops	COO, Finance Manager	Payouts, invoicing, reconciliation	Email, once the champion is engaged

Signal map

Signals follow the Signal Playbook's three layers (Signal Playbook). Each one gets a Clay column, a HubSpot custom event and a strength weight.

Layer	Signal	Capture tool	Strength
1st party	Demo form or booking started but not finished	Tally / Webflow → Clay	Hot
1st party	Product sign-up	Webhook → Clay	Hot
1st party	Repeat website visit, pricing page	RB2B (people) + Warmly (companies)	Hot
1st party	Positive reply or click on a sequence	Instantly / HeyReach via OutboundSync	Hot
1st party	Likes, comments or profile visits on our LinkedIn posts	Gojiberry / Jungler / Teamfluence	Warm
1st party	Lead-magnet download or newsletter sign-up	Tally → Beehiiv	Warm
2nd party	Intro or referral from The Team or other partners	Partner form → HubSpot	Hot
2nd party	Engaged with creator-economy voices' posts	Gojiberry / Trigify	Warm
2nd party	Follows a competitor's company page	Apify scrape	Warm
2nd party	Mentions our brand or category keywords on LinkedIn	Clay social listening	Warm
3rd party	Job post for talent manager or brand partnerships roles	Clay jobs / TheirStack / PredictLeads	Warm
3rd party	New agency launched or new creators signed	Clay + Perplexity news / Serper	Warm
3rd party	Former user of a customer joins a new agency	Clay job-change tracking	Hot
3rd party	Agency acquired or rolled up	Clay news	Warm

Following the Awareness Scoring play, each account also gets a HubSpot stage: Identified → Aware (3+ opens or 1 engagement in 30 days) → Interested (a visit, click or warm signal) → Evaluating (a hot signal) → Selecting (open deal).

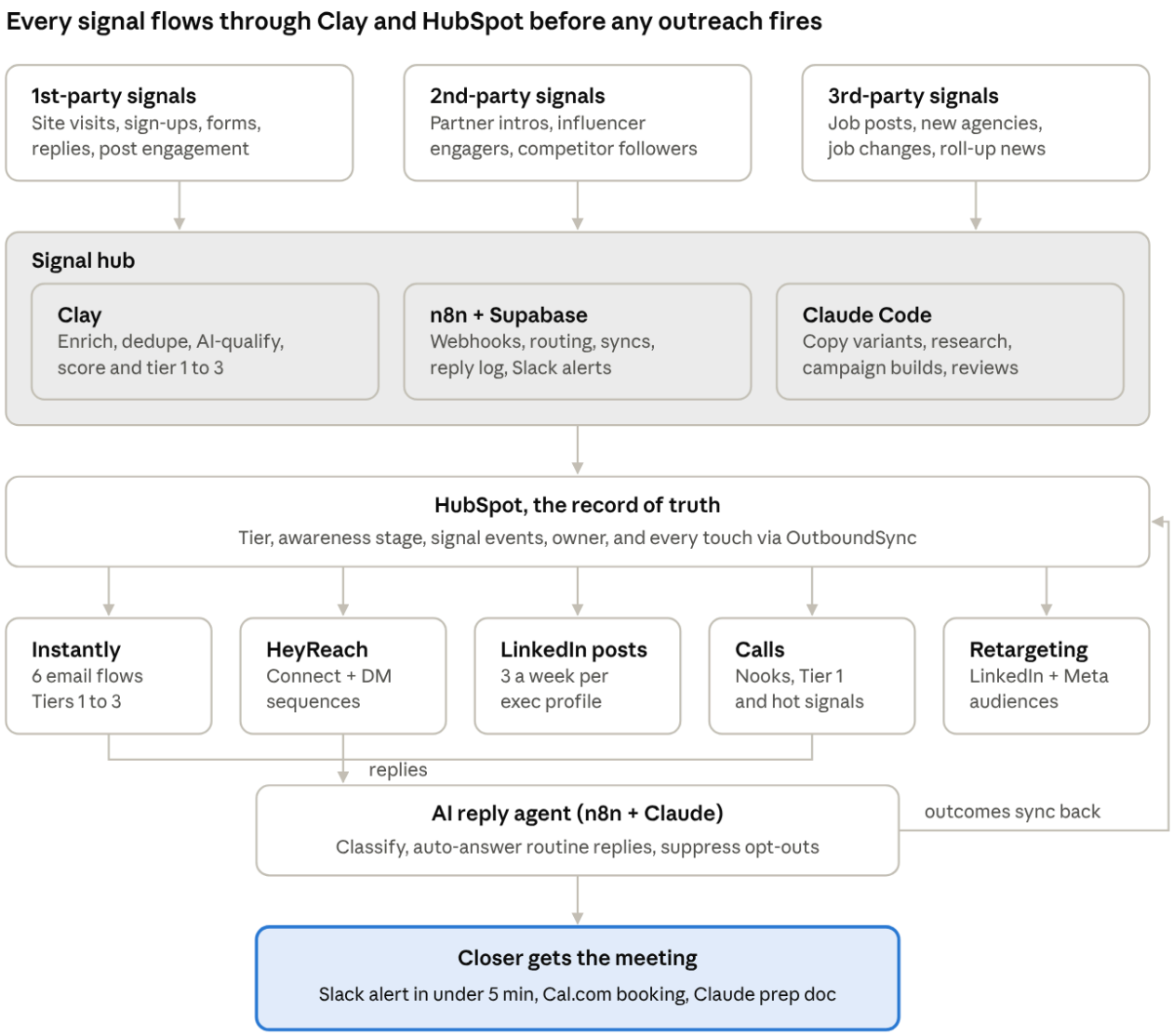


Awareness stages · what moves an account, and what fires

Under each stage: what moves an account into it (grey), and the play it triggers (bold).

Tech stack and data architecture

Clay is the single intake for signals, HubSpot is the single record, and n8n moves data between them. Nothing reaches a sequence until Clay has enriched it, checked it against HubSpot for existing customers and open deals, and given it a tier.



GTM engine architecture · signals to closer

Posts and ads create new engagement, which flows back in as 1st-party signals, so the loop keeps feeding itself.

Tools and their jobs

Layer	Tool	Job in the engine	Play it comes from
Data hub	Clay	Enrichment, AI qualification, scoring, signal tables	Nearly all plays
Orchestration	n8n	Webhooks, reply pipeline, Slack routing, weekly reports	Reply Management
Log and reporting	Supabase	Raw reply and enrichment log, dashboards	Reply Management

Layer	Tool	Job in the engine	Play it comes from
CRM	HubSpot	Record of truth, tiers, awareness stages, deal pipeline	Account Tiering
Activity sync	OutboundSync	Logs every Instantly and HeyReach touch into HubSpot	Outbound Attribution
Email sending	Instantly	Cold and trigger sequences, warmup, inbox rotation	Outbound Playbook
LinkedIn outreach	HeyReach	Connection requests and DM sequences across sender profiles	LinkedIn Social Selling
LinkedIn signals	Gojiberry (Jungler or Teamfluence as backups)	Post engagers, profile visitors, keyword and competitor tracking	Employee LinkedIn Engagement
Scraping	Apify	Competitor page followers, creator posts, agency rosters	Competitor Followers
Website identity	RB2B + Warmly	Person- and company-level visitor identification	Visitor De-anonymization
Contact data	Findymail + BetterContact	Verified emails, then a phone number waterfall	Inbound Orchestration
AI layer	Claude Code + Claude API	Copy, research, reply classification, campaign builds, weekly reviews	AI-Native Operations
Content	Notion + Ordinal	Content calendar, approvals, LinkedIn scheduling	LinkedIn Content x Claude Code
Forms and booking	Tally + Cal.com	Qualifying forms, routed booking	Meeting Form Orchestration
Nurture	Beehiiv or HubSpot email	Newsletter and nurture flows	Organic LinkedIn Lead Gen
Calls	Nooks (phase 2)	Parallel dialing for Tier 1 and hot signals	Warm Calling
Alerts	Slack	Lead cards, reply alerts, approvals	All routing plays
LinkedIn inbox	Kondo	Labels and reminders in the DM inbox	LinkedIn Social Selling

Company brain. Following AI-Native Operations, keep a `/wiki` repo (ICP, personas, objections, case studies, call transcripts) and a `/skills` folder of Claude Code skills. Suggested first skills: build-list, write-sequence, launch-campaign, classify-reply, draft-post and weekly-review. Every automated flow in this plan reads from that wiki, so the copy stays on-message.

Enrichment hygiene. Use the Automated CRM Enrichment flag: every record gets `Enriched by Clay = true` and never re-enters the loop for 12 months, so credits aren't spent twice. Run the CRM Cleanup dedupe on domains every quarter.

Play library: all workflows.io plays mapped to XYZ

All 56 published plays were reviewed. 17 run in Phase 1 because they build the data layer, outbound, replies and inbound. Most of the LinkedIn and signal plays come in Phase 2, and calls, ABM, ads and SEO in Phase 3. Templates and near-duplicates share a row. The "Feeds" column points to the flow IDs in sections 5–7: E = email, R = replies and inbound, L = LinkedIn.

Play	How XYZ uses it	Feeds	Phase
GTM Roadmap 2026 + GTM Funnel + GTM Flywheel	Overall shape. Build data routing and scoring first, since everything downstream depends on them	All	Phase 1
Signal Playbook 2026 + Signal Activation	Signal map (section 2), Clay as the hub, five activation channels, round-robin owner assignment	All	Phase 1
ICP Modeling Guide	Pull won and lost agencies from the past 12–18 months, have Claude Code find shared traits, backtest the tiers	Scoring	Phase 1
TAM Mapping + Account Sourcing	Build the full list of US talent agencies from Apollo, AI Ark, Ocean.io lookalikes, LinkedIn and scraped directories. A cheap model does a yes/no qualify before paid enrichment	E1	Phase 1
Custom Web Scraping (Python)	Scrape agency roster pages for creator count, niches and contact pages, which feeds the roster-size score	Scoring	Phase 1
HubSpot Account Tiering	Tier and missing-data properties, plus workflows that re-tier accounts when data changes	All	Phase 1
Automated CRM Enrichment	New HubSpot records trigger a webhook into Clay. The `Enriched by Clay` flag stops re-enrichment	All	Phase 1
AI-Native Operations	Wiki and skills repo for Claude Code; MCPs for HubSpot, Slack and Notion	All	Phase 1
Automated Outbound 2026	Volume, micro and signal campaign types; contacts split into decision maker, champion and user	E1, E5	Phase 1
Automated Cold Outbound with Claude Code	Claude Code enriches, tiers, writes variants from one human-written baseline, and pushes campaigns to Instantly and HeyReach	E1–E5, L3	Phase 1
Cold Outreach Message Playbook	Copy rules for every flow: a reason-first opener, 1–4 body elements, one CTA, a signal-based P.S., under 80 words	All copy	Phase 1
Complete Outbound 2026	Four evergreen trigger sequences, plus 60 minutes a day of manual LinkedIn prospecting on Tier 1	E2, E5	Phase 1
Reply Management System + Reply Enrichment template	Instantly and HeyReach webhooks into n8n; clean, classify and enrich each reply; Slack cards with action buttons	R1, R2	Phase 1
Outbound Attribution	OutboundSync logs every touch, and `Outbound Campaign` and `Sign Up` flags catch silent conversions	KPIs	Phase 1

Play	How XYZ uses it	Feeds	Phase
Meeting Form Orchestration + template	Tally demo form → Clay → HubSpot lookup → check persona or ICP → assign owner → follow-up	R3	Phase 1
Inbound Orchestration 2026	Two-field form, booking shown only to qualified leads, Claude prep doc, HeyReach connection request before the call	R3, L6	Phase 1
Website Visitor De-anonymization + template	RB2B and Warmly visitors → Clay → tier → Slack alert for Tier 1 → email that references the visit	E3	Phase 1
Founder Connections	Export Jacob's and the team's LinkedIn connections, then qualify and tier them. The fastest early pipeline	E2, L3	Phase 2
LinkedIn Social Selling 2026	Build the audience, warm it with profile visits, comments and light DMs, then track the five warm signals	L1–L5	Phase 2
LinkedIn Content Playbook	Content mix of 50% top-of-funnel, 25% mid and 25% bottom; writer, designer and editor roles	L1	Phase 2
LinkedIn Content OS 90-day + Notion Dashboard	Three posts a week, weekly metric reviews, repurpose winners; Notion calendar and kanban	L1	Phase 2
LinkedIn Content x Claude Code	Claude Code writes three draft variants into Notion, scores hooks and schedules in Ordinal	L1	Phase 2
Human-in-the-Loop Content OS	AI supports and a human writes; nothing posts without approval	L1	Phase 2
Data-Trained AI Content Engine	Scrape top creator-economy and talent-manager posts with Apify, then train a Claude Project on their hooks and formats	L1	Phase 2
Employee-Led Content	Match each team member's profile to a persona, give each 3–4 pillars, run quarterly posting contests	L1	Phase 2
Track Employees' LinkedIn Engagement	Engagers and profile visitors on team profiles → Clay → tiered DMs and email	L4, E4	Phase 2
Organic LinkedIn Lead Gen	Profile optimisation, then a comment-to-get lead magnet delivered by DM through a Tally form	L2	Phase 2
Scrape Influencers' LinkedIn Engagement	Track engagers on posts by creator-economy voices and talent-agency founders	E4, L3	Phase 2
Competitor Page Followers	Use Apify to pull followers of competitor and adjacent tool pages, then send them a pain-led sequence	E4	Phase 2
Social Listening	5–10 keywords such as "talent manager", "brand deal", "creator payments" and "influencer invoicing"; engagers get tiered outreach	E4, L3	Phase 2
Awareness Scoring + Multi-Thread Inbound	Five HubSpot stages; when a Tier 1 account shows up, source 2–3 more contacts there	L5	Phase 2

Play	How XYZ uses it	Feeds	Phase
Product Sign-Up Outreach + Personal Email Enrichment + HubSpot Custom Code	Many managers sign up with Gmail, so reverse-look them up to find the agency; custom code for scoring	R4	Phase 2
Customer Alumni	Users who leave a customer agency to join or start another get a warm "you already know us" flow	E5	Phase 3
Warm Calling	Nooks parallel dialing for Tier 1 and hot signals: calls every 2–3 days for Tier 1, weekly for Tier 2	E2	Phase 3
ABM Playbook 2026	Top 100 agencies plus The Team (Wasserman) roll-up targets: 1:1 microsites, warm intros, retargeting	E2, L5	Phase 3
LinkedIn Ads	At about $9K a year per account we are under the play's $10K bar, so use retargeting only (engagers, visitors, Tier 1)	Ads	Phase 3
LinkedIn Brand Mentions	Once people start mentioning XYZ , their engagers get outreach	E4	Phase 3
Content + Outbound Flywheel	Link the LinkedIn profile CTA to sign-up and tie content series to outbound angles	L1, E1	Phase 3
SEO + AEO	Pages that answer questions like "how talent agencies manage brand deals" and "creator payout software", visible to both Google and LLMs	Inbound	Phase 3
Content RAG Agent	A Slack content agent over the wiki, call transcripts and posts	L1	Later
LinkedIn-to-Blog + News Publishing	Turn winning posts into blogs; a creator-economy news feed with approval before publishing	Inbound	Later
PLG-to-Sales HubSpot	Once platform volume data syncs, score expansion and new-roster growth	Expansion	Later
CRM Cleanup	Quarterly domain dedupe and field audit	Hygiene	Later
Vibe Coding for GTM	Internal GTM dashboard or tier-review app in Lovable and Claude Code	Ops	Later
X Engagement Signal	Talent managers are more active on LinkedIn and Instagram, so revisit only if X shows buyers	E4	Later
ABM Playbook 2025	Replaced by the 2026 version	—	Skip

Automated outbound email flows

Six Instantly flows cover every way an agency enters the engine. Each flow has its own trigger and copy angle. The US talent-agency market is likely only a few thousand accounts (confirm during the TAM build),

so the engine is tuned for relevance, not volume. Burning the list with generic blasts would cost more than it earns.

Sending infrastructure

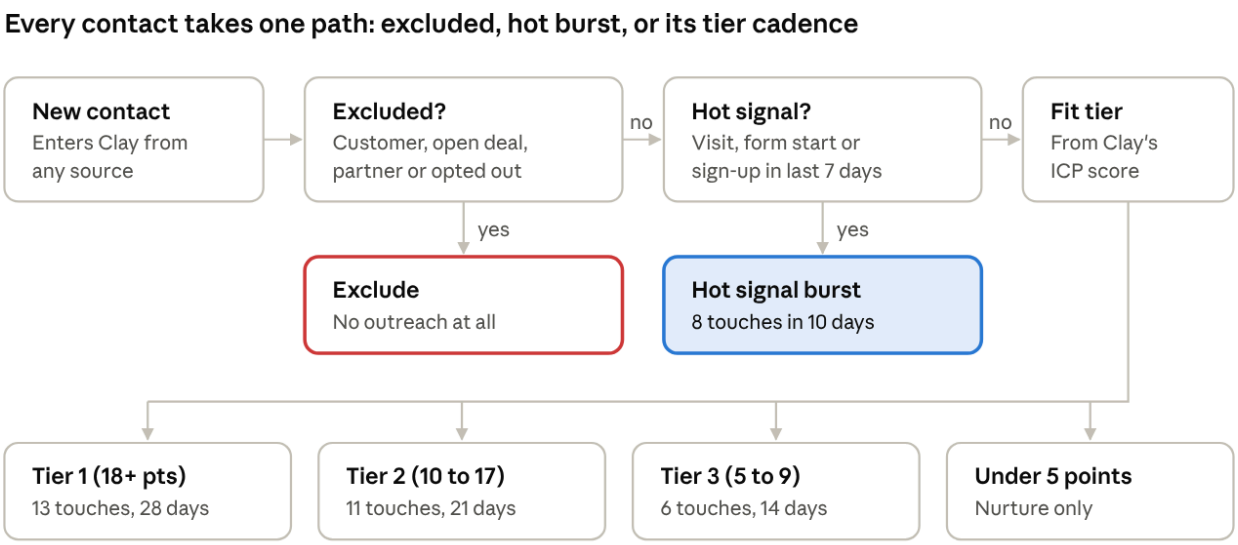
Item	Setting
Domains	4–6 secondary domains (such as XYZconnecthq.com), never the main domain; each redirects to the main site
Inboxes	2–3 per domain, 12 to start, mixed Google and Microsoft; real names (Jacob plus the GTM team)
Authentication	SPF, DKIM and DMARC on every domain; custom tracking domain
Warmup	Pre-warmed inboxes for weeks 2–4 so sending starts early; own domains get 14–21 days of Instantly warmup and take over from week 4. Keep warmup running permanently
Daily cap	30 cold sends per inbox per day, so about 360 a day across 12 inboxes
Tracking	Step 1 plain text with no links and no open pixel; judge on replies, not opens
Compliance	CAN-SPAM footer with a physical address and a one-line opt-out on every email
Health gates	Pause an inbox if bounces pass 2% or spam complaints pass 0.1%. Verify every address with Findymail before sending

Rules that apply to every flow

- **One active sequence per contact.** A HubSpot `Active sequence` property blocks double enrollment. At most two contacts per agency are in sequences at once.
- **Always exclude** customers, open deals, partners (including The Team), and anyone who opted out or said "not interested" in the last 12 months.
- **Any reply stops every channel.** n8n hears the reply webhook and pauses the contact in both Instantly and HeyReach within a minute.
- **Copy rules** (Cold Outreach Message Playbook): open with the reason for writing (relevance, something observed, or a recent event); use 1–4 body elements; ask one CTA; add a P.S. only when there's a real signal; stay under 80 words.
- **Personalization pipeline.** Clay research columns → Claude writes `first_line` and `signal_line` from the wiki → a second Claude pass checks every claim against the research, confirms the email is under 80 words, and blocks banned phrases → anything that fails gets a fallback line.
- **Testing.** Two variants per step. Pick a winner after 200 sends each, based on positive reply rate. Claude Code writes the next challenger every Monday.

How a contact gets routed

Every contact passes the same three checks before anything sends. Exclusions come first, a fresh hot signal beats tier, and otherwise the fit score picks the cadence.

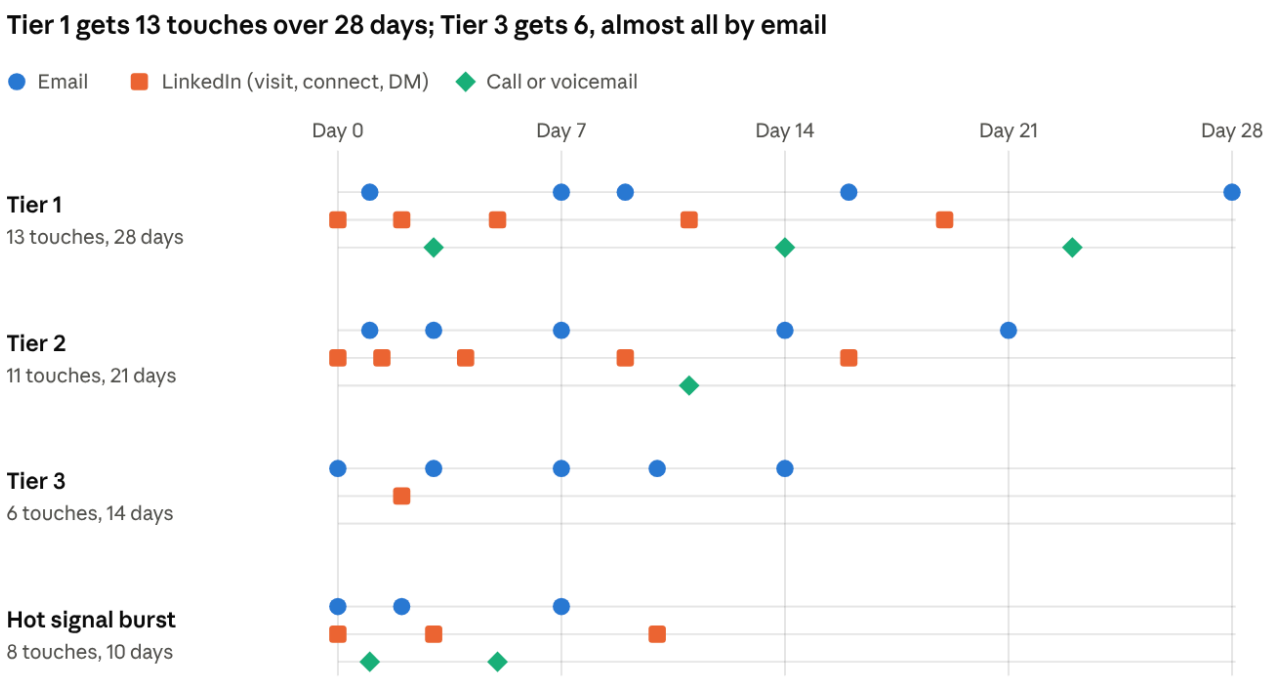


Contact routing · 3 checks, 6 outcomes

The flows below (E1–E6) decide the angle and copy; this routing decides how many touches a contact gets.

Touch cadence by tier

Tier 1 and 2 contacts get 10–13 touches spread across email, LinkedIn and calls, so no single channel is overloaded. Tier 3 stays mostly email to protect the small TAM. Every flow (E1–E5) runs on its contact's tier cadence; the flow only changes the angle and copy. Any reply stops every lane.



Touch cadence by tier · email, LinkedIn and calls per day

Each row has three lanes — email on top, LinkedIn in the middle, calls at the bottom. Calls start in week 2: reps dial manually from HubSpot using BetterContact numbers, and Nooks adds parallel dialing in weeks 5–6. Passive touches (liking their posts, retargeting ads) run on top and aren't counted.

Tier 1 — 13 touches over 28 days (sender: Jacob; multi-thread a second contact from day 14 on the Tier 2 cadence)

#	Day	Channel	Touch
1	0	LinkedIn	Profile visit and like a recent post
2	1	Email 1	Claude-researched, founder-to-founder: proof of homework + the outcome
3	2	LinkedIn	Connection request with a short note
4	3	Call 1	Call, voicemail if no answer
5	5	LinkedIn DM 1	A question, not a pitch
6	7	Email 2	Same thread: a concrete outcome for a similar agency
7	9	Email 3	60-second Loom made for their agency
8	11	LinkedIn DM 2	A resource or relevant post
9	14	Call 2	Reference the Loom
10	16	Email 4	One-page teardown of their deal and payout workflow
11	19	LinkedIn DM 3	Voice note with a soft CTA

#	Day	Channel	Touch
12	23	Call 3	Last call, voicemail
13	28	Email 5	Close the loop, door open; move to ABM audience

Tier 2 — 11 touches over 21 days (sender matched to persona)

#	Day	Channel	Touch
1	0	LinkedIn	Profile visit
2	1	Email 1	Observation + pain + soft CTA
3	1	LinkedIn	Connection request, no note
4	3	Email 2	Same-thread bump: one outcome, one question
5	4	LinkedIn DM 1	After accept: a question about their workflow
6	7	Email 3	New thread: proof from a similar agency
7	9	LinkedIn DM 2	A resource
8	11	Call	Call, voicemail if no answer; references email 3
9	14	Email 4	Resource CTA (template or benchmark)
10	16	LinkedIn DM 3	Soft CTA for 15 minutes
11	21	Email 5	Referral ask, then exit to nurture

Tier 3 — 6 touches over 14 days

#	Day	Channel	Touch
1	0	Email 1	Observation + pain + soft CTA
2	2	LinkedIn	Connection request, no note
3	3	Email 2	Same-thread bump
4	7	Email 3	Proof point
5	10	Email 4	Resource CTA
6	14	Email 5	Referral ask; back to the pool after 90 days only if a new signal fires

Hot signal burst — 8 touches over 10 days (website visits, form starts, sign-ups; any tier)

#	Day	Channel	Touch
1	0	Email 1	Within 24 hours; angle from the page or signal
2	0	LinkedIn	Connection request
3	1	Call 1	Call every tier; voicemail if no answer

#	Day	Channel	Touch
4	2	Email 2	Short proof point + Cal.com link
5	3	LinkedIn DM 1	After accept: a relevant resource
6	5	Call 2	Voicemail if no answer
7	7	Email 3	Resource CTA
8	10	LinkedIn DM 2	Soft close; then their tier's cadence resumes after 30 days if no reply

Per-person ceiling: no one gets more than 13 touches in 30 days. Account-level volume grows through multi-threading, not by adding steps.

Flow E1 — Cold ICP (Tier 2–3, no signal yet)

Trigger: the account is in HubSpot as Tier 2–3 with no active signal. **Contacts:** founder or CEO plus one talent manager. **Angle:** manager time lost to deal admin and payment chasing.

Cadence: Tier 2 contacts run the 11-touch Tier 2 cadence; Tier 3 contacts run the 6-touch Tier 3 cadence (see Touch cadence by tier).

> **Sample step 1** (under 80 words)\ Subject: brand deals at {{agency}}\ Hi {{first_name}} — {{first_line}}. Most agency teams we talk to lose hours a week chasing brand payments and rebuilding deal trackers by hand. XYZ puts deals, contracts and creator payouts in one place, so managers spend that time closing the next deal. Worth a quick look?\ P.S. {{signal_line}}

Flow E2 — Tier 1 founder-to-founder (multichannel)

Trigger: the account is Tier 1 or was pulled from the founders' connections. It sends from Jacob's name. **Contacts:** 2–3 per account, one of each role. Slack creates a manual task for every human step.

Cadence: the 13-touch Tier 1 cadence. A second thread to the head of talent starts on day 14 on the Tier 2 cadence, from the closer.

Flow E3 — Website visitor and hot signal

Trigger: RB2B or Warmly logs 2+ page views or a pricing-page visit, or a started but unfinished demo form, from a Tier 1–3 account. **Timing:** first touch within 24 hours. Tier 1 also gets a Slack alert and a same-day manual touch. Never write "I saw you on our site." Lead with timing and relevance instead.

Cadence: the 8-touch hot signal burst. Step 1's angle comes from the page they read: pricing → how the % model works; payouts page → payout pain.

Flow E4 — Engagers (content, influencers, competitors, keywords)

Trigger: Gojiberry, Apify or Clay social listening captures someone who liked or commented on our posts, engaged with creator-economy voices, followed a competitor's page, or posted about a tracked keyword. **Angle:** the topic of the post they engaged with. Comments rank above likes, and likes above follows.

Cadence: the contact's tier cadence, with email 1 and the connection note referencing the post or topic they engaged with.

Flow E5 — Trigger events

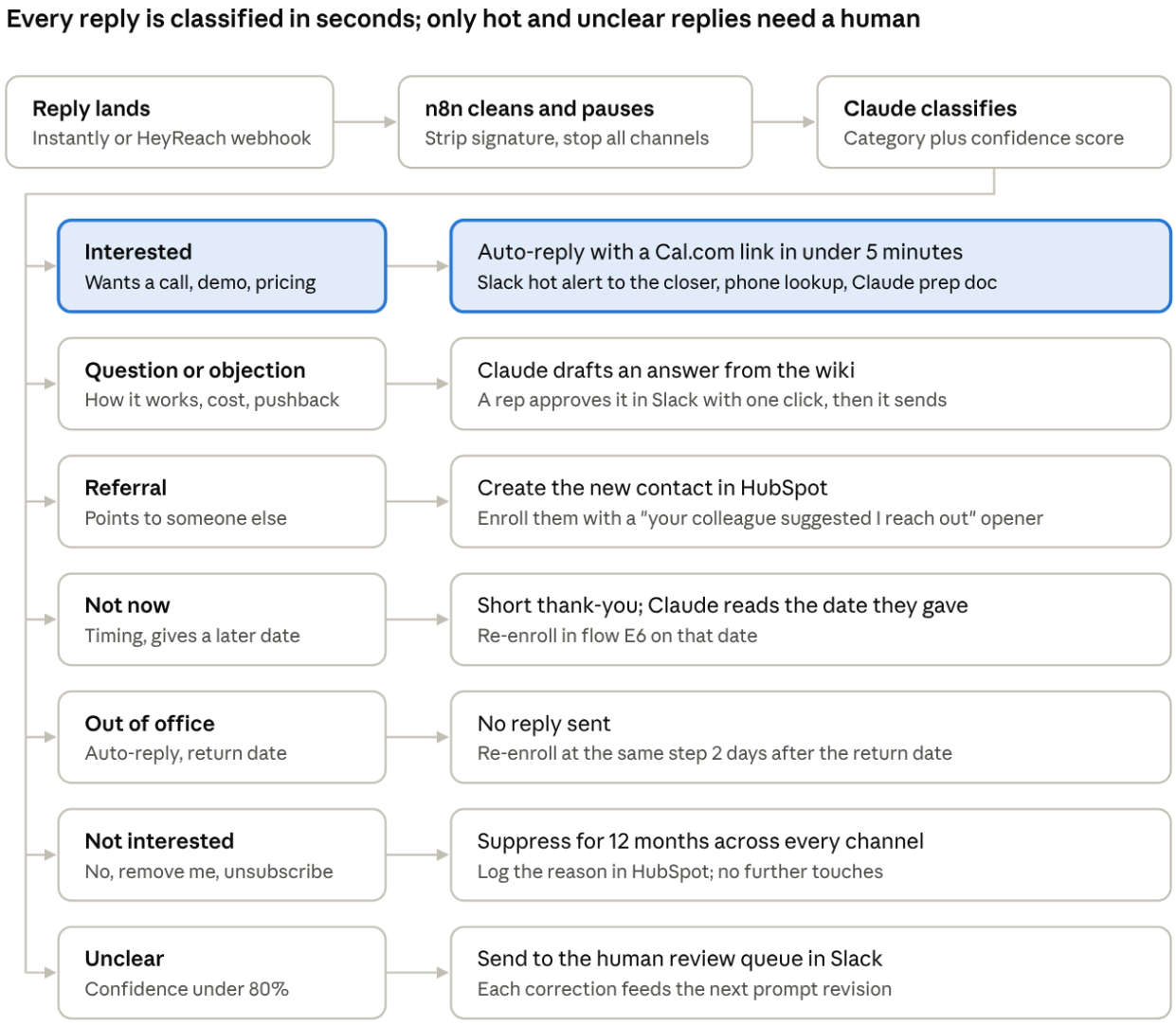
Trigger (Clay monitor)	Angle for step 1	Steps
Job post for a talent manager or brand partnerships role	"Scale deal volume without adding headcount for the admin"	Their tier's cadence
New agency launched or large roster signing	"Set up deals and payouts properly from day one"	Their tier's cadence
A former user at a customer agency joins or starts another agency (Customer Alumni)	"You ran deals on XYZ at {{old_agency}}; want it at {{new_agency}}?"	Hot signal burst, then their tier's cadence; Tier 1 gets a Slack task
Agency acquired or joins a roll-up	"Standardize deal ops across the group"	Moves into E2, the founder track

Flow E6 — Re-engagement

Situation	Action
Out of office	Parse the return date and re-enroll at the same step 2 days after it (fully automatic)
"Not now" or "reach out in Q1"	Claude reads the date; HubSpot schedules re-enrollment with a "following up as promised" opener
Meeting no-show	Same-day reschedule email with a Cal.com link, a LinkedIn DM on day 1, email on day 4, then nurture
Closed-lost	After 120 days, re-open with a new feature or case study, aimed at the objection logged on the deal
Finished a sequence with no reply	Newsletter nurture; re-enter after 90 days only if a new signal fires

Automated reply handling and inbound flows

One n8n pipeline handles every email and LinkedIn reply. It pauses the contact everywhere, classifies the reply with Claude, and acts within 5 minutes. People see only the hot replies and the unclear ones. The design follows the Reply Management System, which uses 4 categories; ours splits them into 7.



Reply routing · 7 categories

Interested replies are the only ones that bypass human review, because speed-to-lead wins them. Everything a human corrects goes back into the classifier prompt.

Flow R1 — The reply pipeline, node by node (n8n)

1. **Webhook intake.** Instantly sends the "Lead replied" event and HeyReach sends "Message received", both to one n8n endpoint.
2. **Pause everywhere.** Instantly API: pause the lead in every campaign. HeyReach API: stop the lead. HubSpot: set `Active sequence = none`.
3. **Normalize.** Claude (a small, fast model) strips HTML, signatures, disclaimers and quoted history, and maps both channels to one schema: contact, channel, campaign, step, reply text.
4. **Log.** Write the raw and cleaned reply to Supabase for dashboards and audits.
5. **Classify.** Claude returns JSON: `{category, confidence, return_date, referral_name, referral_email, objection_type, summary}`. The prompt includes the wiki's objection list and 20

labelled examples.

6. **Enrich hot leads.** For Interested and Question replies, Clay adds a phone number through the BetterContact waterfall, and the company record gets a 3-line summary.
7. **Act.** Route by category, as in the diagram above.
8. **Notify.** A Slack card goes to #replies-hot or #replies-review with the reply, summary, tier, a link to the source signal, and buttons: open in HubSpot, LinkedIn, approve draft, edit draft, re-classify.
9. **Sync.** OutboundSync and HubSpot record the reply, category and next step. Interested replies create a deal in the "Meeting requested" stage.

Auto-send policy

Category	Weeks 1–4	After 4 weeks at 95%+ accuracy
Interested	Auto-send booking link + alert the closer	Same
Out of office, not interested, not now	Automatic	Same
Referral	Draft for approval	Auto-send
Question or objection	Draft for approval	Auto-send the top 5 objection types, with a 10-minute Slack undo window
Unclear	Human	Human

Accuracy is checked every week. A human labels a sample of 50 replies, and if the error rate passes 5% (the Reply Management play's threshold), Claude Code rewrites the prompt with the new examples.

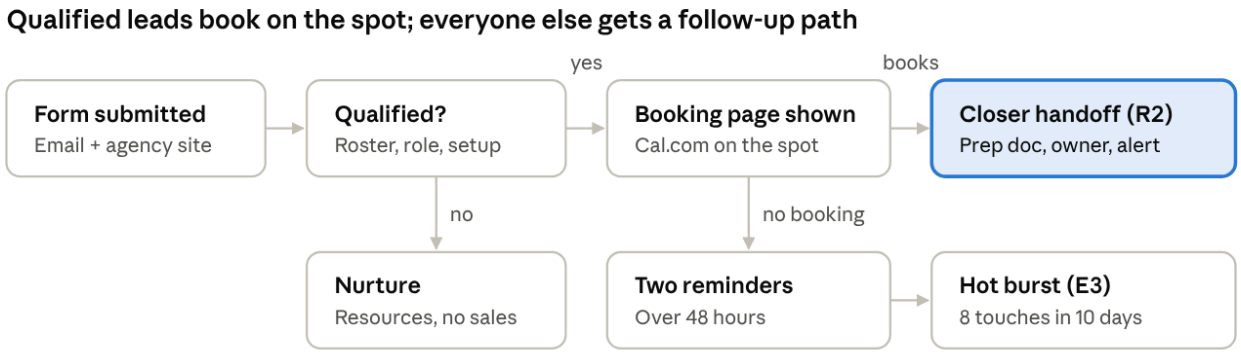
Flow R2 — Hot-lead handoff to the closer

1. Interested reply or booked meeting → HubSpot deal created, owner assigned by round-robin, or the account owner if one exists.
2. Claude writes a prep doc covering agency overview, roster, signals that fired, the full thread, likely objections and a suggested talk track. It is saved to a HubSpot property and posted to Slack (Inbound Orchestration).
3. HeyReach sends a LinkedIn connection request from the closer before the call.
4. If nobody books within 24 hours, a one-line email nudge and a manual Slack task follow. After 72 hours, flow E6 takes over.
5. After the meeting, the closer's notes set the deal stage and trigger a follow-up email draft.

Flow R3 — Inbound forms and demo requests

Step	What happens	Tool
1	A two-field form (email, agency website) and a Tally qualifying form: roster size, role, how deals and payouts are handled today	Webflow / Tally

Step	What happens	Tool
2	Qualified answers get the Cal.com booking page on the spot; unqualified ones get resources and nurture	Tally logic, Cal.com
3	Webhook into Clay: enrich, look up in HubSpot, create or associate the company and contact	Clay, HubSpot
4	Anyone who starts the form without booking gets two reminders over 48 hours, then flow E3	HubSpot email, Instantly
5	Booked meetings go through R2: prep doc, owner, Slack alert, LinkedIn connection	Claude, Slack, HeyReach



Inbound form flow (R3) · 3 outcomes

No inbound lead is dropped: qualified leads book, form-starters get reminders then the hot burst, and poor fits get nurture.

Flow R4 — Product sign-ups

1. A sign-up webhook goes into Clay, which tags the email as work or personal. Managers often sign up with Gmail.
2. For personal emails, a reverse lookup (Findymail, Apollo or Freckle) finds their LinkedIn profile and agency (Personal Email Enrichment).
3. The account is scored and tiered, synced to HubSpot, and gets `Sign Up = true` for attribution.
4. Tier 1 gets a Slack alert, a founder-signed personal email within 1 hour, and a LinkedIn connection request. Tiers 2–3 get an onboarding nurture triggered by product milestones, such as a first deal logged or a first payout.

LinkedIn posting and DM flows

LinkedIn does two jobs: it warms the market through content, and it converts people who show interest through DMs. Scheduling, drafting and signal capture are automated. The founder's voice, comment replies and Tier 1 DMs stay human. Posts go out through Ordinal, which uses LinkedIn's official API, so the automation risk sits with DMs. Section 8 covers the limits.

Flow L1 — Content engine (3 posts a week per executive)

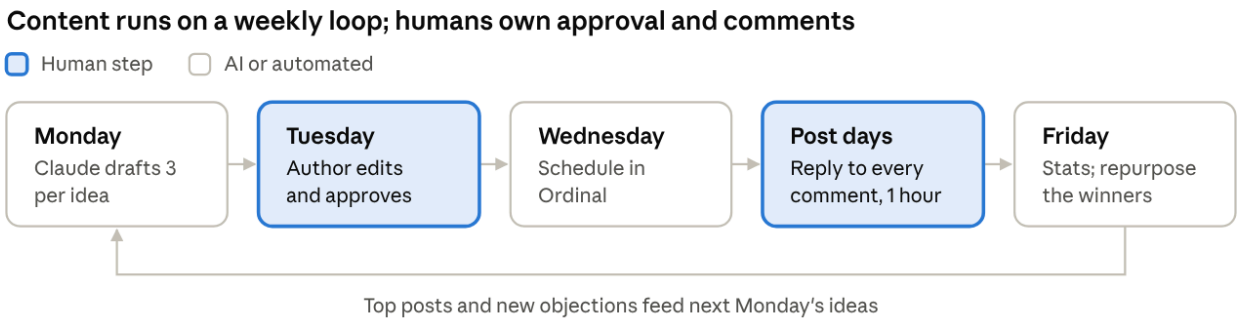
Profiles. Jacob posts on founder vision, the business of talent management and building in public. The closer posts deal teardowns and talent-manager pain points. The GTM team posts ops playbooks. The company page is for reposts and hiring only, because personal profiles get 5–8x more engagement (Employee-Led Content).

Pillars and mix (LinkedIn Content Playbook)

Pillar	Top of funnel (50%)	Middle (25%)	Bottom (25%)
The business of talent management	Deal economics, rate trends, getting paid on time	"How top agencies price brand deals" frameworks	Customer before-and-after on deal volume
Agency operations playbooks	Stories from managers	Checklists, templates, old way vs new way	XYZ walkthroughs
Building XYZ	Build-in-public, the founder's story	Product decisions explained	Launches, partner news (The Team), case studies

Weekly production loop (Claude Code `draft-post` skill + Notion + Ordinal)

Day	Step	Automated or human
Monday	Ideation: Claude pulls call transcripts, the week's reply objections, trending creator-economy posts (Apify scrape + Gojiberry) and wins from HubSpot, then writes 9 idea briefs in Notion	Automated
Monday	Drafting: Claude writes 3 variants per chosen idea in each author's voice, trained on their past posts (Data-Trained Content Engine)	Automated
Tuesday	Each author picks, edits and approves. Nothing posts without approval (Human-in-the-Loop Content OS)	Human, 30 minutes per author
Tuesday	Hook scoring against the top-post dataset, fact check, visuals from Figma or Canva templates	Automated + designer
Wednesday	Schedule Monday, Wednesday and Friday posts in Ordinal at 8–9am Central	Automated
Post day	Reply to every comment within the first hour (the author)	Human
Friday	Analytics pull: impressions, saves, profile visits, DMs, and signals created. Winners get turned into carousels, lead magnets and blogs (LinkedIn-to-Blog)	Automated

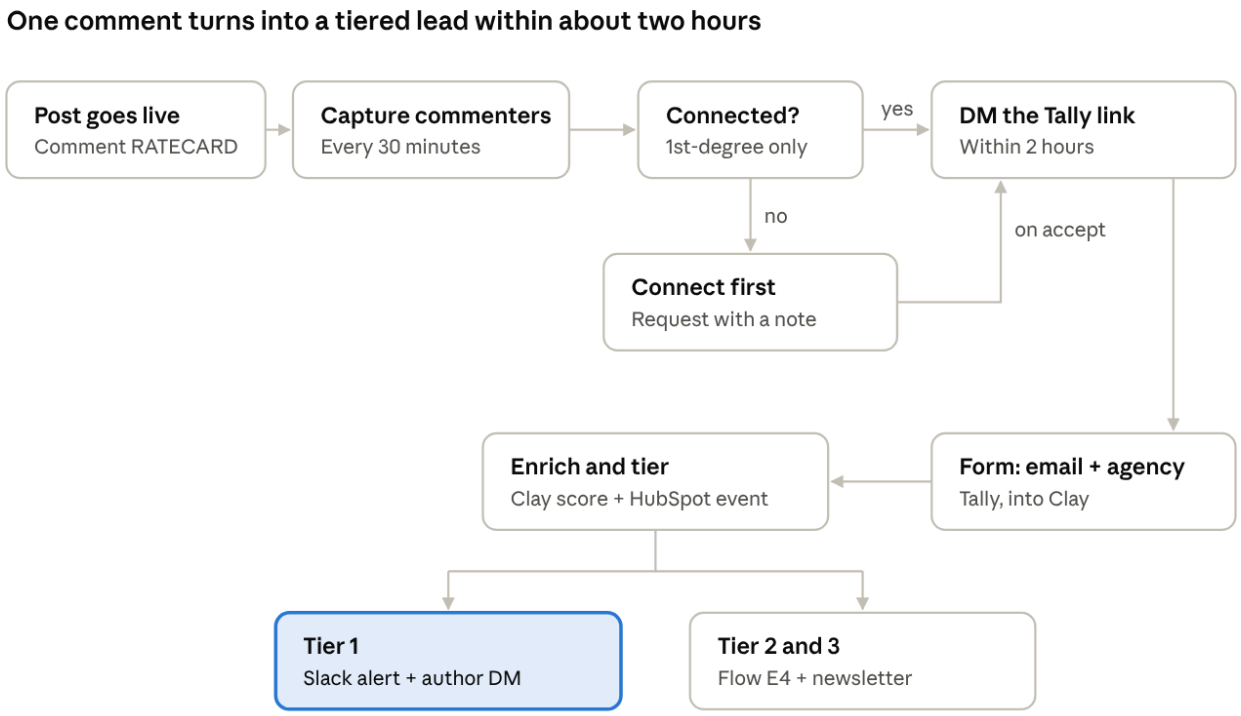


Weekly content loop (L1) · 5 steps

AI does the drafting, scheduling and analysis; the two blue steps stay human, because approval and comment replies decide how the posts land.

Flow L2 — Lead magnet: comment to get it (monthly)

1. Each month, build one asset for managers, such as a brand-deal rate-card template, a creator payout ops checklist, or a "state of agency deal ops" benchmark.
2. Post it: "Comment RATECARD and I'll send it over."
3. HeyReach or Gojiberry picks up commenters every 30 minutes. First-degree connections get a DM with a Tally link within 2 hours. Everyone else gets a connection request with a note, and the DM goes out once they accept.
4. The Tally form collects email and agency. Clay enriches and tiers the lead, and HubSpot records a signal event.
5. Tier 1 gets a Slack alert and a personal follow-up DM from the author. Tiers 2–3 get flow E4 by email plus the Beehiiv newsletter.



Lead magnet flow (L2) · comment to tiered lead

Non-connections take one extra step (a connection request), then join the same path once they accept.

Flow L3 — Signal-based connect + DM sequence (HeyReach)

This runs alongside flows E1–E5 for any contact with a LinkedIn URL. The sender is matched to the persona: Jacob writes to founders, and the closer or GTM team writes to talent managers.

Step	Timing	Action	Sample
1	Day 0	Profile visit	—
2	Day 1	Connection request (no note converts best when cold; use a note when there's a signal)	"Saw your take on {{topic}}. I work with talent agencies on deal ops, would be good to connect."
3	Accepted + 1 day	DM 1: a question, not a pitch	"Curious how {{agency}} handles brand payments today. Still spreadsheets and invoice chasing, or have you found something better?"
4	Accepted + 4 days	DM 2: something useful	A related post, template or 60-second Loom
5	Accepted + 9 days	DM 3: soft CTA	"Happy to show how agencies like yours run deals and payouts in one place. Worth 15 minutes next week?"
6	14 days without acceptance	Withdraw the request	Keeps the account's acceptance rate healthy

Flow L4 — Post engagers and profile visitors

1. Gojiberry (or Teamfluence) exports engagers and profile visitors from every team profile to Clay each day (Track Employees' Engagement).
2. Clay qualifies, tiers and removes customers, students and non-US contacts.
3. First-degree Tier 2–3 contacts get an automatic DM within 24 hours: "Thanks for jumping into the {{post_topic}} thread" plus a question. Everyone else goes into L3 with a note that mentions the post.
4. Tier 1 contacts get a Slack card for a human DM from the post's author, plus flow E2.

Flow L5 — Tier 1 warming and multi-threading

1. For two weeks before any outreach, follow the founder and head of talent, and like or comment thoughtfully on two of their posts. This is manual, in the 60-minute daily block from the Complete Outbound play.
2. Launch E2. Jacob writes to the founder and the closer writes to the head of talent, so there are two senders and two threads.
3. The account goes into a LinkedIn and Meta retargeting audience (ABM Playbook).
4. Any engagement from the account alerts its owner in Slack.

Flow L6 — Around meetings

- **Before the call:** the closer sends a connection request once the meeting is booked (R2).
- **After the call:** Claude drafts a recap DM from the meeting notes, and the closer approves and sends it.
- **No-show:** a DM on day 1 alongside the E6 email.

HeyReach sender setup

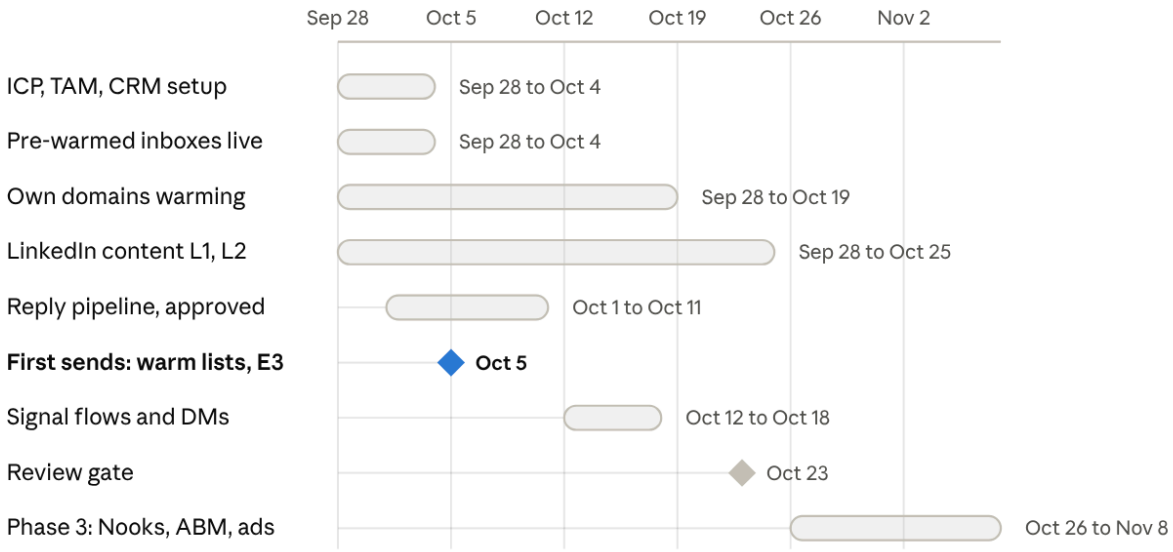
Setting	Value
Sender profiles	3–4 real team members who have agreed to it (Jacob, the closer, 1–2 GTM team), aged accounts with Sales Navigator
Connection requests	20–25 per profile per day, weekdays only
Messages	50–80 per profile per day, with randomized delays, during business hours
Acceptance rate	Keep it above 30%; if it drops, tighten targeting before adding volume
Inbox	HeyReach unified inbox + Kondo labels; every reply goes through R1
Never automate	Comments, posting from fake accounts, or messages that pretend to be manual when a real person is expected to be present

Rollout, KPIs and guardrails

The core engine is built in 4 weeks. First sends go out on Oct 5, 2026 from pre-warmed inboxes, and the review gate on Oct 23, 2026 decides what Phase 3 (calls, ABM, ads, SEO) scales in weeks 5–6. Data routing and scoring still come first, as the GTM Roadmap advises, but everything else runs in parallel: Aakash on data and replies, a second owner on LinkedIn content.

First sends go out in week 2; the review gate lands at the end of week 4

4-week build, 2026, weekly gridlines; Phase 3 follows in weeks 5 and 6



4-week build · then Phase 3 in weeks 5–6

Week by week

1. **Week 1:** ICP, TAM and HubSpot setup; buy own domains and pre-warmed inboxes; export founder connections; start posting 3x a week and the first lead magnet (L1, L2).
2. **Week 2:** First sends at about 15 per inbox per day to the warmest lists (founder connections, website visitors via E3). The reply pipeline runs with every reply human-approved. HeyReach profiles start at about 10 connection requests a day. Calls begin, dialed manually from HubSpot.
3. **Week 3:** Add engager and trigger-event flows (E4, E5) and the DM flows (L3, L4). Pre-warmed inboxes go to full volume.
4. **Week 4:** Own domains finish warming and start taking volume. Review gate at the end of the week.

Trade-offs of the 4-week pace: pre-warmed inboxes cost more and wear out sooner, so shift volume to your own domains from week 4. The review gate runs on about two weeks of sends, so treat it as directional rather than statistically settled.

Review gate criteria

- 70%+ of positive replies come from Tier 1–2 accounts; if not, re-weight the scoring. With two weeks of data, a clear direction is enough; re-check at week 8.
- Reply classification accuracy is 95%+ on a 50-reply sample, which unlocks auto-send for questions.
- Every inbox has bounces under 2% and spam complaints under 0.1%.
- LinkedIn acceptance rate is above 30% on every sender profile.

KPIs

These are starting targets. Reset them at the review gate using real data.

Metric	Starting target	Where it's measured	Reviewed
Qualified meetings booked	20+ a month by week 8	HubSpot deals, "Meeting booked" stage	Weekly
Email positive reply rate	Above 1.5% cold, above 4% signal flows	Instantly + Supabase	Weekly
LinkedIn acceptance rate	Above 30%	HeyReach	Weekly
LinkedIn DM reply rate	Above 8%	HeyReach	Weekly
Time from interested reply to booking link	Under 5 minutes	n8n logs	Daily alert if missed
Meeting show rate	Above 75%	Cal.com + HubSpot	Weekly
Signals created by content	Tracked, with a target set at the review gate	Gojiberry + Clay	Weekly
Pipeline influenced by outbound	Tracked via `Outbound Campaign` flag	HubSpot attribution	Monthly
Won agencies and platform volume	Per closer's plan	HubSpot	Monthly

Weekly self-improvement loop

Every Monday, a Claude Code `weekly-review` skill does four things:

1. Pulls Instantly, HeyReach, HubSpot and Supabase stats.
2. Ranks flows, steps, variants, signals and tiers by positive reply rate and meetings.
3. Writes new challenger copy for the weakest step, proposes scoring weight changes, and lists the objections the wiki doesn't cover.
4. Posts a one-page report to Slack for the GTM team to approve.

Once approved changes go live, the loop repeats. This follows the Outbound Playbook's weekly reporting step and the AI-Native Operations skills model.

Guardrails

- **Deliverability.** Never send cold from the main domain, verify every address, and pause inboxes automatically when they breach the health thresholds.
- **Compliance.** Every email has a CAN-SPAM opt-out and physical address. Opt-outs are honoured across all channels within 24 hours.
- **LinkedIn risk.** LinkedIn's terms restrict third-party automation, so a sender profile can be limited or banned. Use conservative limits, aged accounts and real team members who have agreed to it. Keep content posting on the official API through Ordinal.
- **Human gates.** Humans own posts, Tier 1 first touches and objection replies until accuracy is proven. AI never promises pricing, integrations or terms that aren't in the wiki.
- **Data.** Exclude customers, partners and open deals before every send. Nobody gets two sequences at once.

The brand product runs through the same engine with its own ICP (brands doing influencer marketing), lists, copy and Slack channels. Launch it after the week-4 review gate, on its own inboxes, so the two don't compete for capacity.

Sources

All 56 plays at workflows.io/workflows were read on 2026-09-27 and are linked in section 4.